

The Prospecting Playbook

How we find companies that demonstrably have the problem wrk.ai solves, and prove it to them with evidence they can verify themselves in ten seconds.

Version 1.0 Date 13 August 2026 Basis 32 prospects sourced, 4 methods measured

Every competitor emails "we are an AI CRM." Nobody replies, because that claim is about the seller. We only send claims about the buyer.

1. What we are actually selling

Not a feature list. One sentence, and it is the whole thesis:

A small team whose customers talk to them on WhatsApp and Instagram, where those conversations are invisible to the business.

The provable version, and the one that gets replies: *your revenue conversations live on someone's personal phone, and you are buying ads to send more of them there.*

The scoring inversion (read this twice)

The instinct is to target companies paying a lot for tooling. That is backwards. The best prospect has **many customer front doors and nothing behind them**: WhatsApp, Instagram, email, a contact form, and no CRM or shared inbox. The pain is unowned rather than merely expensive, and there is nothing to rip out.

PROOF THE SCORING IS RIGHT
Decorpot scored 100 out of 100 on our own scorer, and Decorpot is **already a wrk customer**. The scorer independently rediscovered the profile we already sell to. That is also why we keep a suppression list.

2. The four sourcing methods, ranked by measured yield

Each was actually run and counted. The numbers below are measurements, not estimates.

METHOD	BEST FOR	COST	YIELD	VERDICT
Meta Ad Library	WhatsApp-first SMBs	Free	17 of 27	Best method we have
Published directories	Agencies, 30 to 70 staff	Free	15 of 19	Strong, needs websites
Funding reports	Early-stage startups	Free	5 of 7	Best founder names
Apify LinkedIn posts	Founder intent	\$0.42	0 of 180	Do not repeat

Public, no login, no API key, no cost. Our single best source.

Businesses running **click-to-WhatsApp ads** are paying Meta for leads that land in an inbox nobody owns. That is not an inference we are making about them, it is a receipt. It is the strongest buying signal in the entire playbook.

The one trick that makes this work

Searching a vertical on its own returns the wrong companies entirely: large brands driving traffic to websites, sorted by ad spend. **Pair the literal token "whatsapp" with the vertical.** That single change moved the hit rate from 1 in 84 to 17 in 27.

```
# Wrong. Sorts by impressions, returns big D2C brands with web destinations.
country=IN q=skincare -> 1 / 84 WhatsApp CTAs

# Right. The quoted token makes the result set click-to-WhatsApp dense.
country=IN q="whatsapp" interior design -> 17 / 27
country=IN q="whatsapp" study abroad -> 15 / 23
country=AE q="whatsapp" interior fit out -> 20 / 29
```

What to extract per advertiser

- Advertiser page name and Facebook page URL
- **Destination URL**, decoded out of Meta's `l.facebook.com` link shim. This is how you get their real website to audit.
- Ad start date, which tells you how long they have been paying
- Whether the CTA is WhatsApp or Send Message

De-duplicate to **one row per advertiser, not per ad**. A single business often runs the same creative many times and will otherwise dominate the batch.

TWO THINGS THAT WILL TRIP YOU UP

It returns 403 after sustained use. Switch to a different browser profile and it clears immediately.

It is the wrong tool for non-WhatsApp pools. UAE recruitment agencies returned 1 domain in 13, because they advertise straight into WhatsApp with no website at all. No website means nothing to audit.

2 Published directories **STRONG**

Free. The right tool when you need companies that definitely have websites.

Ranked-list articles ("top 20 agencies in Pune") are curated, current, and hand you a company name plus a domain plus a staff count. We pulled 19 Pune agencies this way and 15 became draftable prospects.

Why agencies are the highest-value pool

An agency needs the product **twice**: internally for 30 to 70 staff (attendance, leave, payroll, tasks) and commercially for client work (proposals, contracts, invoices, one inbox per client). It is also the only pool that can **resell**, which is exactly the segment GoHighLevel takes.

Filter by size. We dropped every firm above roughly 100 staff. A 200-person agency already runs Darwinbox and HubSpot and is the wrong motion for a \$14.99 per seat product. The sweet spot is 30 to 70.

3 Funding reports **BEST NAMES**

Free. Weekly roundups from Entrackr, Inc42, YourStory.

Early stage is the correct instinct, and here is precisely why: a company that just raised has budget, is hiring, and has **no incumbent stack to rip out**, so switching cost is zero. A 200-person company has already bought everything. A six-person one has a WhatsApp group and a spreadsheet.

Funding coverage also names founders, which is what makes these leads messageable on LinkedIn. It produced our two verified founder profiles.

THE BEST TIMING SIGNAL WE HAVE FOUND

One prospect raised \$5.5M and **launches on 1 September**. Pre-launch means the ops stack is being chosen right now and there is no history to migrate. That window is roughly two weeks wide and it does not come back. Look for launch dates, not just round sizes.

Filter hard on stage. Ignore Series B and above. Keep seed and small Series A where the customer base is consumer or trade facing, because that is where WhatsApp and Instagram are genuinely the channel.

4 Apify LinkedIn post search FAILED

Cost \$0.42. Returned 180 posts and zero usable leads.

Documented so nobody repeats it. We searched LinkedIn posts for founders asking which CRM or shared inbox to use. Rejection breakdown:

REASON REJECTED	POSTS
No ops keyword and no early-stage tell	67
Too long, all thought-leadership on inspection	43
Promotional or self-marketing	42
Content marketing dressed as a question	12
Vendor or agency author	10

WHY IT FAILED, AND THE LESSON

LinkedIn post search is dominated by engagement-optimised content. Founders asking genuine questions get little reach and are rare: the measured base rate is about 1 percent, so 180 posts should produce one or two, and produced none. **That is a base-rate problem, not a tuning problem.** Better queries would not have fixed it, so we stopped rather than spend the rest of the budget.

3. The audit, which is the actual differentiator

Sourcing finds a company. The audit is what earns the reply. Every check is free and, except the response-time probe, scriptable.

CHECK	HOW	WHAT IT GIVES YOU
1 Stack detection	Fetch the homepage plus /contact and /about, regex for vendor script tags	Their exact tool list and real monthly spend
2 Ad Library	Search their page name, filter by country	Active ad count, CTA type, spend duration
3 Response-time probe	Manual, top 20 only. One genuine buying question to their WhatsApp, timestamped	The single most powerful line available
4 Hiring signal	Careers page, LinkedIn Jobs, public ATS boards	"You are about to pay a salary to solve this"
5 Team size	LinkedIn company page	Seat maths in their currency
6 Front-door count	Aggregate of check 1	"Five ways in, no shared inbox"

The output is **one sentence of evidence** you can paste into an email. Real examples from live prospects:

- Five separate branch inboxes (info, chandni, gandhinagar, ghatkopar, goregaon), a live WhatsApp number, and both Meta and Google ads running into all of it, with no CRM anywhere.

- Enquiries arriving at a Gmail address, alongside an Instagram account.
- Paying for a WhatsApp-only tool, with email, Instagram DMs and deal history somewhere else entirely.

RULE ON THE MONEY NUMBER

Quote the prospect's **detected** stack, never our marketing "replaces \$400 a month" figure. That number sums list prices of 17 tools and a founder will call it out. Also never quote our estimated dollar total, because it is seat count times list price and therefore a guess. **Name the tools, not the number.**

RULE ON THE RESPONSE-TIME PROBE

One message, a real question, never a follow-up nag, and **always disclose it in the email**. If you would not be comfortable with them knowing you timed it, do not do it. Cap it at the top 20 prospects and never automate it.

4. Copy rules, enforced by a linter not by taste

Each rule below is a failure someone already paid for. Our drafting tool refuses to emit anything that breaks them, which is the point: judgement does not scale, a check does.

- 1 **No em dashes, en dashes, or middle dots.** Reads as AI-generated and kills reply rate.
- 2 **60 to 95 words of pitch.** Measured on the body, excluding greeting and signature. Longer gets skimmed and deleted.
- 3 **No links in email one.** Links in a cold first touch hurt deliverability. The audit video goes in follow-up two.
- 4 **One question mark.** A binary ask beats a soft "let me know."
- 5 **Never greet a prospect by a scraped name.** Derive the greeting from the address you are actually sending to, and fall back to "Hi there" whenever it is not clearly a person.
- 6 **Never write to careers@ or hr@.** A vendor pitch to a recruiting inbox is ignored.
- 7 **Never send to a domain with no MX record.** It bounces, and bounces cost sender reputation.

REAL MISTAKES THE LINTER CAUGHT BEFORE THEY WENT OUT

"Hi **Careers**," on a mail addressed to sales@, because the greeting and the envelope came from different places.

"Hi **Acaddcntr**," which is a company mailbox, not a person.

"Hi **Anilbhat**," a first and last name run together.

Drafts addressed to **no-reply@**, where a reply is impossible by construction.

5. Three claims we deleted, and why it matters

Credibility is the only asset in cold outreach and it is spent permanently. Both of these were written, then removed before sending.

WHAT WAS WRITTEN

WHY IT WAS CUT

"Saw the same shape at three other interiors firms this month"

We could not back it. Replaced with "Decorpot runs on us", a public logo the prospect can verify.

"We run the interiors side for Decorpot"

Decorpot is a customer, but we do not know which modules they use. Claiming knowledge we lack collapses on the call.

"Proposal, contract, timesheet and invoice are *probably* four different tools"

"Probably" is a guess wearing a fact's clothes. Rewritten as a question, which is honest and easier to answer.

DO NOT SELL THESE. THEY ARE NOT PRODUCTION READY.

AI meeting notetaker is disabled in production, yet it is feature two on our own landing page. Highest vapour risk we have.

Lead discovery across six platforms defaults to Reddit only.

Ziwo voice is code-ready but blocked on credentials.

Public REST API, Meta and Google Ads orchestration: do not exist.

Sell WhatsApp, unified inbox, CRM, workflows, email campaigns, people and HR. Those carry live customer traffic. An email that overpromises and then dies in the demo is worse than no email.

6. Sending, which is the real bottleneck

An earlier campaign on this system automated sourcing and drafting perfectly and left sending as a vague intention. **Twelve warm, fully drafted leads went cold unsent over four days.** Finding people is never the constraint.

- 20 emails per day, hard cap**, spread through the day. A 35-in-two-minutes burst measurably hurt deliverability once already.
- Plain text, one to one.** No HTML, no tracking pixel, no image signature.
- Set up Google Postmaster Tools before the first send**, and seed-test three drafts into Gmail, Outlook and Yahoo. Confirm the primary inbox, not Promotions.
- Follow up 3, 7, 7**, always in the same thread. Day three is the audit video and it is the highest-converting asset we have. It is also the one most likely to be skipped.
- If drafted-but-unsent exceeds 10, stop sourcing entirely and send.** More prospects is never the answer when the queue is already full.

7. Where to start on Monday

- Pick one vertical where your customers plausibly use WhatsApp.
- Search the Ad Library for "whatsapp" <your vertical> in your country. Expect roughly half to be genuine click-to-WhatsApp advertisers.
- Pull the destination URLs. Those are your audit targets.
- Run the stack check on each. Keep the ones with many front doors and nothing behind them.
- Write one sentence of evidence per prospect. If you cannot, you do not have a prospect yet.
- Send 20 a day, and put the day-three follow-up in your calendar before you send the first one.

If you cannot show it to them, do not claim it. Everything in the email should be something the prospect can verify on their own website in ten seconds.

wrrk.ai Prospecting Playbook v1.0 / 13 August 2026 / Every number in this document was measured, not estimated. Tooling and raw data live in [wrrkhunt/](#).